JAMES ROBERTS

Senior Infrastructure & Platform Engineer | Linux / UNIX | Reliability | Technical Operations

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior infrastructure and technical operations professional with 20+ years of commercial UNIX/Linux experience across business-critical, regulated and high-availability environments. Strong background in incident/problem management, disaster recovery, resilience, production change, migrations and technical leadership. Current commercial work includes AWS BAU support, Zabbix monitoring and Grafana, alongside hands-on automation, virtualisation, observability and Infrastructure as Code.

CORE SKILLS

- UNIX / Linux: Red Hat, Debian, Ubuntu
- Disaster Recovery & Business Continuity
- High Availability, Resilience & Recovery
- Incident, Problem & Change Management
- AWS BAU support
- Automation: Bash, Ansible, PowerShell
- Monitoring: Zabbix, Grafana
- Virtualisation: VMware, Proxmox
- Leadership, mentoring & stakeholder engagement
- 3rd-line escalation & technical delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Appello Group — Third Line Product Support Technician

Sept 2025 – Present

- 3rd-line escalation point for complex incidents and service requests; mentor 1st- and 2nd-line technicians and support SLA-focused delivery.
- Part of the AWS support team, providing BAU support for AWS-hosted services and assisting with day-to-day operational issues.
- Implemented Zabbix alerting/monitoring and Grafana dashboards for critical services, improving service-health visibility and earlier issue detection.

Yunex Traffic — Infrastructure Manager

Jan 2025 – Jul 2025

- Managed and mentored a team of five engineers supporting AWS-supported infrastructure and acted as an escalation point for complex issues.
- Owned day-to-day availability, scalability and performance, driving improvements in automation, monitoring and deployment practices.
- Worked closely with development, security and compliance teams to align infrastructure delivery with business and regulatory requirements.

LV= — Technical Business Continuity & Disaster Recovery Manager

Sept 2020 – Dec 2024

- Defined technical DR requirements for business-critical services and verified that delivered solutions met recovery needs.
- Planned and executed annual recovery testing aligned with regulatory requirements, coordinating multi-team physical DR exercises.
- Produced post-test reports, remediation actions and follow-up plans to improve resilience and recovery readiness.

LV= — Technical Operations Analyst (UNIX)

Apr 2012 – Sept 2020

- Provided UNIX operational support in a 24/7 enterprise environment, resolving incidents to SLA and acting as a senior escalation point.
- Helped run day-to-day team operations, owned cross-team issues and technically led key service transitions to an offshore third party.
- Technical lead for a major enterprise data-centre migration in 2018.
- Automated Red Hat Linux patching using Bash, later moving the process to Ansible to improve consistency, control and maintainability.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

- Communication & stakeholder engagement: clear, practical communicator comfortable working with technical teams, customers, suppliers and senior stakeholders, translating complex issues into understandable actions and decisions.
- Leadership, mentoring & ownership: experienced in mentoring engineers, taking ownership of escalated issues, coordinating across teams, supporting colleagues and driving work through to resolution in high-pressure operational environments.

EARLIER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Hampshire County Council — Level 2 IT Consultant

Jan 2008 – Apr 2012

- Key member of business-critical project teams and member of the Technical Change Control Board.
- Responsible for enterprise UNIX platform migrations; technical lead for hosted LAMP deployment and Red Hat upgrade work.
- Installed and supported Red Hat on VMware, IBM Content Manager/DB2 and enterprise monitoring-platform upgrades.
- Administered virtualised UNIX environments; performed backups/restores, DR testing and participated in a 24/7 support rota.

Rias plc / JRL plc — IT Support Roles

1998 – 2008

- Progressed from Help Desk to 1st Line, 2nd Line and 3rd Line Systems Support, providing enterprise incident resolution and user support.

INDEPENDENT ENGINEERING LAB & PORTFOLIO

Personal engineering environment used to keep professional infrastructure skills current and develop modern platform/DevOps capability. This is clearly separate from commercial production experience.

- Built and operate a resilient two-node Proxmox cluster hosting core services including DNS, monitoring, security, collaboration and container management workloads.
- Hands-on with Terraform, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes/k3s, Jenkins CI/CD and Git-based infrastructure/change management.
- Implemented multi-host observability with Prometheus, Grafana, Loki and Grafana Alloy, including dashboards, alerting and centralised log pipelines.
- Applied practical security engineering through vulnerability scanning, network monitoring, hardening, patch management and documented remediation workflows.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE) – historical certification, No. 804005459617933 | ITIL v3 Green Badge | HND Computer Studies (Year 1), University of Central Lancashire | BTEC units in IT Systems, Communications & Programming | GCSEs including English & Maths